

EK369E: Financial Markets

Bond Prices and Yields

Problem Set (with solutions)

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Problem 1

Consider a 6% coupon bond selling for NOK 93.3 with three years to maturity making annual coupon payments. This bond is redeemable at maturity at par value.

- a) Calculate the bond's yield to maturity (YTM).

Solution 1a.

Redemption/par value of the bond: NOK 100

Coupon payments on this bond: 6% of 100 = NOK 6

Therefore, the YTM can be solved using the equation:

$$93.3 = \frac{6}{(1+YTM)^1} + \frac{6}{(1+YTM)^2} + \frac{100+6}{(1+YTM)^3}$$

Using the trial and error method

The YTM of this bond must be higher than 6% since the bond is trading at a discount. Given the difference between the bond's price and the par value, we can begin with a YTM of 7.5% and increase incrementally until we get the price that equates the present value of inflows to the present value of out flows.

We can also speed up the process by using the annuity formula to discount the coupon payments of the bond. Annuity formula = $\frac{1-(1+YTM)^{-T}}{YTM}$

@YTM = 7.5%

$$P_0 = 6 \left[\frac{1-(1.075)^{-3}}{0.075} \right] + \frac{100}{(1.075)^3}$$

$$P_0 = (6 \times 2.6005) + 80.4961 = 96.099$$

This price is higher than 93.3, so we increase the YTM by 1%

@YTM = 8.5%

$$P_0 = 6 \left[\frac{1 - (1.085)^{-3}}{0.085} \right] + \frac{100}{(1.085)^3}$$

$$P_0 = (6 \times 2.5540) + 78.291 = 93.61$$

This price is slightly higher than 93.3, so we increase the YTM by 0.1%

@YTM = 8.6%

$$P_0 = 6 \left[\frac{1 - (1.086)^{-3}}{0.086} \right] + \frac{100}{(1.086)^3}$$

$$P_0 = (6 \times 2.5494) + 78.0747 = 93.37$$

This price is approximately the same as 93.3, we can conclude that the YTM is approximately 8.6%

Solving as a polynomial equation to the degree 3

We set $(1 + YTM) = x$

$$93.3 = \frac{6}{x^1} + \frac{6}{x^2} + \frac{106}{x^3}$$

$$93.3 = \frac{6x^2 + 6x + 106}{x^3} \quad (\text{by finding the Least common multiple on the right side of the equation above})$$

$$93.3x^3 - 6x^2 - 6x - 106 = 0 \quad (\text{by cross multiplying (or multiply both sides of the the equation above by } x^3) \text{ and equate to zero})$$

Solving for x using equation mode on your calculator yields:

$$x = 1.086 \therefore \underline{\underline{YTM = 0.086 \text{ or } 8.6\%}}$$

Solving for YTM using a financial calculator

Bond Information	Financial Calculator Input	Value
Time to Maturity	N	3
Par value	FV	100
Current price	PV	-93.3
Coupon payment	PMT	6
YTM	CPT + I/Y	<u><u>8.63</u></u>

The financial calculator can solve for any other missing information about the bond by simply inputting the available bond information and pressing “CPT + missing information”. For example to solve for the current price of the bond, I input the information for N, FV, I/Y, PMT and press “CPT + PV”

- b) If interest rates over the next three years will be, with certainty, $r_1 = 6\%$, $r_2 = 8\%$ and $r_3 = 10\%$, calculate the realised compound average return on this bond.

Solution 1b

The compound rate or return takes into consideration income from reinvested coupon payments over three years plus capital gain and satisfies the relationship $V_0(1+r)^3 = V_3$

where V_0 is the invested amount, V_3 is the settlement amount at the end of year 3 and r is the Geometric/Time Weighted/ Compound Return.

Description	Cash flow
1st coupon received at t = 1 and reinvested	$6 \times 1.08 \times 1.1 = 7.13$
2nd coupon received at t = 2 and reinvested	$6 \times 1.1 = 6.6$
3rd coupon received	6
Bond redemption	100
Settlement amount	119.73

Invested amount (V_0) is NOK 93.3

Settlement amount (V_3) is NOK 119.73

$$\text{Geometric/Time Weighted/ Compound Return} = \sqrt[3]{\frac{119.73}{93.3}} - 1 = \underline{\underline{8.7\%}}$$

Note that the compound rate of return is not equal to the YTM ($8.7 \neq 8.6$) since coupon was not re-invested at the YTM.

If the coupon received was reinvested at the YTM of 8.6%

Description	Cashflow
1st coupon received at t = 1 and reinvested	$6 \times 1.086 \times 1.086 = 7.07$
2nd coupon received at t = 2 and reinvested	$6 \times 1.086 = 6.52$
3rd coupon received at t = 3	6
Bond redemption	100
Settlement amount	119.59

Invested amount (V_0) is NOK 93.3

Settlement amount (V_3) is NOK 119.59

$$\text{Geometric/Time Weighted/ Compound Return} = \sqrt[3]{\frac{119.59}{93.3}} - 1 = \underline{\underline{8.6\%}}$$

Problem 2

A 20 Year maturity bond with par value of NOK 100 makes annual coupon payments at 8%. Find the yield to maturity of the bond if the bond's price is

- a) NOK 95
- b) NOK 100
- c) NOK 105

Solution to Problem 2

Solution 2a.

Before making computations, we know that a bond trading at a discount must have its YTM greater than its coupon rate. We can verify this by computing YTM using the financial calculator.

Bond Information	Financial Calculator Input	Value
Time to Maturity	N	20
Par value	FV	100
Current price	PV	-95
Coupon payment	PMT	8
YTM	CPT + I/Y	<u>8.53%</u>

Solution 2b.

Without computations, we know that a bond trading at par has its YTM equal to its coupon rate. We can verify this by computing YTM using the financial calculator.

Bond Information	Financial Calculator Input	Value
Time to Maturity	N	20
Par value	FV	100
Current price	PV	-100
Coupon payment	PMT	8
YTM	CPT + I/Y	<u>8.00%</u>

Solution 2c.

Before making computations, we know that a bond trading at a premium must have its YTM less than its coupon rate. We can verify this by computing YTM using the financial calculator.

Bond Information	Financial Calculator Input	Value
Time to Maturity	N	20
Par value	FV	100
Current price	PV	-105
Coupon payment	PMT	8
YTM	CPT + I/Y	<u>7.51%</u>

Problem 3

Fill in the table below for the following zero-coupon bonds with par values of NOK 100.

Price	Years to Maturity	Yield To Maturity (YTM)
NOK 40	20	a)
NOK 50	20	b)
NOK 50	10	c)
d)	10	10%
e)	10	8%
NOK 40	f)	8%

Solution to Problem 3

Solution 3a.

Bond Information	Financial Calculator Input	Value
Time to Maturity	N	20
Par value	FV	100
Current price	PV	-40
Coupon payment	PMT	0
YTM	CPT + I/Y	<u>4.69%</u>

Solution 3b.

Bond Information	Financial Calculator Input	Value
Time to Maturity	N	20
Par value	FV	100
Current price	PV	-50
Coupon payment	PMT	0
YTM	CPT + I/Y	<u>3.53%</u>

Solution 3c.

Bond Information	Financial Calculator Input	Value
Time to Maturity	N	10
Par value	FV	100
Current price	PV	-50
Coupon payment	PMT	0
YTM	CPT + I/Y	<u>7.18%</u>

Solution 3d.

The price of the bond is $P_0 = \frac{100}{(1.1)^{10}} = \underline{\underline{\text{NOK } 38.55}}$

Bond Information	Financial Calculator Input	Value
Time to Maturity	N	10
Par value	FV	100
Coupon payment	PMT	0
YTM	I/Y	10%
Current price	CPT + PV	<u>-38.55</u>

Solution 3e.

The price of the bond is $P_0 = \frac{100}{(1.08)^{10}} = \underline{\underline{\text{NOK } 46.32}}$

Bond Information	Financial Calculator Input	Value
Time to Maturity	N	10
Par value	FV	100
Coupon payment	PMT	0
YTM	I/Y	8%
Current price	CPT + PV	<u>-46.32</u>

Solution 3f.

$$40 = \frac{100}{1.08^T}$$

$$1.08^T = \frac{100}{40}$$

$$\log(1.08^T) = \log(2.5)$$

$$T \cdot \log(1.08) = \log(2.5)$$

$$T = \frac{\log(2.5)}{\log(1.08)} = \frac{0.3979}{0.0334} \approx 11.9$$

The time to maturity of the bond is approximately 11.9 years

Bond Information	Financial Calculator Input	Value
Par value	FV	100
Coupon payment	PMT	0
YTM	I/Y	8%
Current price	PV	- 40
Time to Maturity	CPT + N	<u>11.9</u>

Problem 4

Bond Alfa has a current yield of 9% and a yield to maturity of 10%.

- a) Is Bond Alfa selling above or below par value?

Solution 4a

A bond selling above par value i.e. a premium bond has a yield to maturity less than its current yield, which is also less than its coupon rate

A bond selling below par value i.e. a discount bond has a yield to maturity greater than its current yield, which is also greater than its coupon rate

Bond Alfa has a yield to maturity greater than its current yield therefore, Bond Alfa is trading at a discount (below par value).

- b) Is the coupon rate on Bond Alfa more or less than 9%?

Solution 4b

Since Bond Alfa is trading at a discount, its coupon rate is less than 9% (i.e. its coupon rate is less than its current yield and its yield to maturity).

Problem 5

A newly issued bond pays its coupons once annually. Its coupon rate is 5%, its maturity is 20 years and its yield to maturity is 8%.

- a) Find the holding period return for a 1-year investment period if the bond is selling at a yield to maturity of 7% by the end of the first year.

Solution 5a.

Price at the beginning of the year (P_0):

$$P_0 = 5 \left[\frac{1 - (1.08)^{-20}}{0.08} \right] + \frac{100}{(1.08)^{20}} = 70.55$$

$$P_1 = 5 \left[\frac{1 - (1.07)^{-19}}{0.07} \right] + \frac{100}{(1.07)^{19}} = 79.33$$

$$HPR_1 = \frac{79.33 - 70.55 + 5}{70.55} = \underline{\underline{0.1953 / 19.53\%}}$$

- b) Continuing from a), find the realised compound yield for a two-year holding period, assuming that you sell the bond after two years, the bond's yield is 7% at the end of the second year and coupons can be reinvested for one year at 3% interest rate.

Solution 5b.

Description	Cashflow
1st coupon received at t = 1 and reinvested at 3%	$5 \times 1.03 = 5.15$
2nd coupon received at t = 2	5
Proceeds from the sale of the bond	79.88
Settlement amount	90.03

Invested amount (V_0) is NOK 70.55

Settlement amount (V_2) is NOK 90.03

$$\text{Realised Compound Yield} = \sqrt[2]{\frac{90.03}{70.55}} - 1 = \underline{\underline{12.965\% \approx 13\%}}$$

Problem 6

The table below summarises some information from the fixed-income market:

Bond	Maturity (years)	Coupon rate (%)	Yield (%)
A	5.5	0	2.5
B	2.5	4.0	2.0

- a) Calculate the invoice price and the flat price for the two bonds.

Solution 6a.

Invoice price = Clean Price + Accrued interest (since last coupon payment)

Bond A

Bond A does not pay coupon, therefore its flat price is the same as its invoice price.

$$P_{0,Clean}^A = P_{0,Invoice}^A = \frac{100}{(1.025)^{5.5}} = \underline{\underline{87.30}}$$

Bond B

Compute the invoice price using the price between coupon dates formula and setting $T = 3$

$$P_{0,invoice}^B = \frac{\frac{4}{0.02} \times [1.02^3 - 1] + 100}{(1.02)^{3-1+0.5}}$$

$$P_{0,invoice}^B = \frac{112.24}{1.0508} = \underline{\underline{106.81}}$$

Accrued interest on Bond B: $0.5 \times 4 = 2$

$$P_{0,Clean}^B = 106.81 - 2 = \underline{\underline{104.81}}$$

b) How can a zero-coupon bond be traded above its face value?

Solution 6b.

A bond trades above its par value when its yield to maturity is less than its coupon rate. For a zero-coupon bond to trade at a premium, its yield to maturity must be less than zero i.e market interest rates must be negative.

Problem 7

Treasury bonds paying an 8% coupon rate with semiannual payments currently sell at par value. what coupon rate would they have to pay in order to sell at par if they paid their coupons annually.

Solution 7

A bond with an annual coupon rate of 8%, paid semiannually, pays 4% of its face value every six months. Since the bond sells at par, its semiannual yield to maturity is also 4%.

For a face value of NOK 100, the first NOK 4 coupon can be reinvested for six months at 4%, earning NOK 0.16. Together with the second NOK 4 coupon, this gives NOK 8.16 at year-end, equivalent to an effective annual yield of 8.16%.

Therefore, to continue selling at par with the same required effective annual yield, the bond must offer an **annual coupon rate of 8.16% when coupons are paid once annually.**

Problem 8

Assume that you have a 1-year investment horizon and are trying to choose among three bonds with the same degree of default risk and the same time to maturity of 10 years. Bond 1 is a zero coupon bond, Bond 2 has a coupon rate of 8%, and Bond 3 has a coupon rate of 10%

- a) If all bonds are currently priced to yield 8% at maturity, what are the prices of Bond 1, Bond 2 and Bond 3

Solution 8a.

$$P_0^{Bond1} = \frac{100}{1.08^{10}} = \underline{\underline{46.32}}$$

$$P_0^{Bond2} = \underline{\underline{100}}$$

$$P_0^{Bond3} = 10 \left[\frac{1 - (1.08)^{-10}}{0.08} \right] + \frac{100}{(1.08)^{10}} = \underline{\underline{113.42}}$$

- b) If at the beginning of next year, all bonds are priced to yield 8% , what will the prices of these bonds be?

Solution 8b.

$$P_1^{Bond1} = \frac{100}{1.08^9} = \underline{\underline{50.02}}$$

$$P_1^{Bond2} = \underline{\underline{100}}$$

$$P_1^{Bond3} = 10 \left[\frac{1 - (1.08)^{-9}}{0.08} \right] + \frac{100}{(1.08)^9} = \underline{\underline{112.49}}$$

Comments:

Holding all else equal and assuming stable interest rates, discount bonds increase in value (approach the par-value) as they approach maturity.

Holding all else equal and assuming stable interest rates, premium bonds reduce in value (approach the par-value) as they approach maturity. This is because the number of high coupon payments, the reason why they were priced above par, reduces as maturity approaches.

In summary, bonds(with similar attributes) are priced such that all investors earn comparable total return (otherwise there would be arbitrage in the bond market).

- c) Based on your answer in a) and b) compute the holding period return over the 1 year horizon for each bond.

Solution 8c.

$$HPR_1^{Bond1} = \frac{50.02 - 46.32}{46.32} = \underline{\underline{7.99\% \approx 8.0\%}}$$

$$HPR_1^{Bond2} = \frac{100 - 100 + 8}{100} = \underline{\underline{8.0\%}}$$

$$HPR_1^{Bond3} = \frac{112.49 - 113.42 + 10}{113.42} = \underline{\underline{7.997\% \approx 8.0\%}}$$

Comments:

With stable interest rates, these bonds are interchangeable as the investor earns the same return regardless.

- d) Recalculate b) and c) if at the beginning of next year, all bonds are priced to yield 7%

Solution 8d.

$$P_1^{Bond1} = \frac{100}{1.07^9} = \underline{\underline{54.39}}$$

$$P_1^{Bond2} = 8 \left[\frac{1 - (1.07)^{-9}}{0.07} \right] + \frac{100}{(1.07)^9} = \underline{\underline{106.52}}$$

$$P_1^{Bond3} = 10 \left[\frac{1 - (1.07)^{-9}}{0.07} \right] + \frac{100}{(1.07)^9} = \underline{\underline{119.55}}$$

$$HPR_1^{Bond1} = \frac{54.39 - 46.32}{46.32} = \underline{\underline{17.42\%}}$$

$$HPR_1^{Bond2} = \frac{106.52 - 100 + 8}{100} = \underline{\underline{14.52\%}}$$

$$HPR_1^{Bond3} = \frac{119.55 - 113.42 + 10}{113.42} = \underline{\underline{14.22\%}}$$

Comments:

When yields fall, bond prices rise, increasing holding period returns compared with unchanged yields. For these bonds with the same maturity and initial yield, the zero-coupon bond is the most sensitive to interest rate changes because all its cash flow occurs at maturity. It therefore experiences the largest percentage price increase from the yield decline and earns the highest holding period return.